

Caryse Chang

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Education

Occidental College

Expected May 2030

- Bachelor of Science, Biology; Public Health and Philosophy Minor

EXPERIENCE

John Muir Health

June 2024 – August 2026

Student Supervisor

June 2024 – August 2025

- Co-lead a 12-person volunteer shift in a high-volume clinic, delegating tasks and ensuring compliance with hospital policies and department coordination
- Serve as primary liaison between clinical staff and the volunteer team, directing services to highest-priority units while advocating for volunteer needs
- Organize team-bonding activities to strengthen shift culture and improve volunteer retention rate

General Volunteer

August 2025 – August 2026

- Transport lab samples, patient discharges, organize and stock department supplies, write patient schedules in PT department, transport medical equipment and other supplies
- Provide comfort to patients, talk to patients, delivering food trays & gifts

Member and Group Leader, *miRcore*

June 2024 – August 2026

- Led a computational biology research team studying the genetic causes of Alzheimer's Disease; research resulted in publication in the *miRcore Science Journal*
- Advocated for public scientific awareness by raising \$10,700 for frontotemporal dementia research, co-running middle school biology workshops with ~500 students, and designing pamphlets promoting vaccination and science literacy
- Mentored 6 freshmen in *miRcore's* Computational Biology summer camp through original research on Parkinson's Disease

Seasonal Principal Cello Coach Camp Counselor, *Lamorinda Summer Music Camp*

June 2023 – June 2026

- Taught group lessons, ensemble coaching, and provided performance opportunities for young musicians' at a summer music camp for local elementary and middle school musicians, reaching 50+ students each summer
- Planned camp activities, organized outreach, and ensured students enjoyed the music experience
- Taught cello, bass, and viola students music technique and theory, and coached chamber groups for a cumulative performance for the *Lamorinda* community

Founder and President, *Note by Note, Campolindo High School*

August 2024 – May 2026

- Founded a community non-profit pairing high school musicians with elementary and middle school students for affordable music instruction
- Grew student enrollment to 117 students in 4 neighboring towns through community outreach, school partnerships, school presentations, and social media
- Manage mentor-student pairings and club funds; trained 50 high school mentors; iterated program structure based on parent and mentor feedback to maintain lesson quality

Orchestra, Campolindo High School & Acalanes High School District

August 2022 – May 2026

Section Leader

August 2024 – May 2026

- Lead cello section of 11 members through weekly sectionals, alternating between full-group instruction and

targeted one-on-one coaching to address varying experience levels

- Selected as cello section leader of the district orchestra, leading 23 cellists during the music program's trip to SoCal
- Advocate as student liaison, representing the section's logistical and musical concerns to the director
- Foster inclusive section culture by organizing and planning social events

Section cellist

August 2022 – May 2024

- Played as the fourth and third chair cellist, teaching younger students and helping foster community through helping previous section leaders plan events

Chamber Group Performer, *Symphony of Service*

June 2022 – July 2025

- Organize and perform with a chamber group of 4 string players, selecting repertoire tailored to each audience
- Performed for 4 senior homes (approximately 35 seniors each) and 2 middle schools over 4 years

BioEngineering High School Competition (BioEHSC), UC Berkeley

February 2022 – April 2025

Seasonal Research Team Captain

February 2025 – April 2025

- Directed a 5-student team through an intensive 7-week bioengineering competition, overseeing the project from problem identification through symposium presentation
- Set weekly research goals, ensured team alignment on progress, and mentored teammates in academic literature review and data synthesis

Researcher

February 2022 – April 2024

- Developed novel solutions to prevalent bioengineering problems; our projects were on treatment of multi-drug resistant tuberculosis, earlier AD diagnosis, and retinitis pigmentosa treatment
- Presented solutions to industry investors and researchers in academia at an all-day conference

PROJECTS

Type 1 Diabetes Research Paper

Independent Author

May 2025 – July 2025

- Independently authored a computational bioinformatics study on the genetic cause of Type 1 Diabetes
- Published in Nexus Research Journal, an international high school research journal, as 1 of 2 accepted papers
- Identified upregulation of genes in the IL-17 signaling pathway as a driver of pancreatic inflammation and beta cell destruction

Health and Happiness Research

Independent Author

April 2025 – June 2025

- Authored independent research paper published in UpNextScientists Research Journal (2025)
- Studied how happiness and health condition correlated by statistically analyzing data collected globally from a survey

Alzheimer's Disease Research 2025 – 2026 Researcher

Lead Author

August 2024 – Present

- Conducting research on Alzheimer's Disease using computational tools to analyze differences in gene expression that may contribute to Alzheimer's pathology
- Publication forthcoming (2025-2026)

Global Life Expectancy and Healthcare Spending

Data Science Researcher

February 2026 – April 2026

- Completed a 7-week data science program, developing Python skills and applying data analysis libraries to an independent research project
- Analyzed the correlation between a country's GDP expenditure on healthcare and average citizen life expectancy

SKILLS

Leadership and Collaboration: Team Building, Adaptable Communication, Conflict Mediation, Cross-Team Collaboration

Research and Advocacy: Computational Biology, Community Outreach, Science Communication, Program Development

Laboratory Techniques: Micropipetting, Gel Electrophoresis, PCR, DNA Extraction and Analysis, Centrifugation, Bacterial Culture and Transformation

Technical: Python, Data Analysis, Bioinformatics Tools

CERTIFICATIONS

- **CNA Certification**, California Public Health Department (2026)
 - Studied 100 hours of theory and 100 hours of clinicals at Chaparral House in Berkeley, CA
- **Biotechnology ROP**, Contra Costa County ROP (2025): Completed biotechnology coursework through CCC ROP, gaining hands-on laboratory skills including micropipetting, gel electrophoresis, centrifugation, PCR, DNA extraction and analysis, and bacterial culture and plasmid transformation.

AWARDS & HONORS

- **Gold Presidential Volunteer Service Award** (2025): Earned the highest level of the Presidential national service award for 250+ hours of community service across senior homes, hospital volunteering, miRcore advocacy, and middle school biology workshops.
- **John Muir Health Auxiliary Scholarship** (2026): One of nine seniors selected for this scholarship recognizing commitment to community service, passion for healthcare, and overall accomplishments.
- **BioOlympiad Honorable Mention**, USA Biology Olympiad (2024): Scored in the top 20% of all test-takers nationwide on the US Biology Olympiad exam.